

TỪ VỰNG & Ý TƯỞNG ĐỂ VIẾT MỌI CHỦ ĐỀ TRONG

IELTS WRITING BY NGOCBACH

CHỦ ĐỀ HEALTH

1. Some people think it is more important for government to **spend public money on promoting a healthy lifestyle** in order **to prevent illness** than to spend it on the **treatment of people** who are **already ill**. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Essay:

It is true that some people argue for more public expenditure on measures to prevent illness by promoting a healthy lifestyle. While this would certainly result in benefits to public health, I disagree with the idea that this should be a higher priority than the treatment of people who are already suffering from illness.

The promotion of a healthy lifestyle to prevent illness is undoubtedly a worthy aim of any government. The **sedentary** routines of many people make them more **prone to** the risk of diabetes or heart disease as a result of their inactivity. In modern life, people are so **caught up in** the pressures of work or study that they neglect the importance of keeping fit. Dependence on the car **exacerbates** the problem of lack of exercise. Thus, government provision of **affordable** leisure and sports facilities, coupled with promotion campaigns to keep fit and

Sedentary [adjective]: in which you spend a lot of time sitting down

prone to [adjective]: likely to suffer from something

be caught up in [phrasal verb]: become involved in something, even when you do not want to be

exacerbate [verb]: to make something worse, such as a problem or a disease

affordable [adjective]: cheap enough so that people can buy it/pay for it

healthy would certainly be a worthwhile initiative to raise the general level of public health. However, in the process of decision-making on health matters, I would argue that expenditure should be allocated first to the treatment of people who are ill. Firstly, not all illnesses are the result of unhealthy lifestyle choices by individuals. For example, respiratory disorders are affected by air pollution in cities, while poor sanitation and contaminated drinking water contribute to outbreaks of dysentery and cholera. Secondly, failure to subsidise medicines or to invest in hospitals would certainly lead to many deaths which could have been avoided by timely treatment. Hospitals, for instance, have many roles in providing treatment, not only surgery but also in conducting vital research into the treatment of many life-threatening conditions, such as cancer or asthma. In conclusion, while promoting healthy living is important, treatment must have priority in health service spending. 298 words	respiratory disorders [noun]: problems related to breathing sanitation [noun]: the systems and equipment that keep places clean, especially by removing human waste contaminated [adjective]: made dirty by adding something that is dangerous or carries a disease subsidise [verb]: give money to an organisation to help to pay for something timely [adjective]: happening at the right time life-threatening [adjective]: likely to kill someone condition [noun]: the state of someone's health or how fit they are
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2. It is **difficult** for people **living in cities** today **get enough physical exercise**. **Why** is this the case? **What** can be done to **solve the problem**?

Essay: The hectic pace of life of many city residents today leaves little time to take regular exercise. When they arrive home exhausted, they lack the energy to practice sports, go to a gym or simply to go for a walk. While this situation is obviously detrimental to people's health, there are effective solutions which could alleviate the problem. Contemporary life in a city is not easy, and incorporating a fitness regime as part of a healthy lifestyle is rarely high on the agenda of busy urban residents. One major factor is a heavy workload, as most industrial and office jobs are physically and mentally demanding. This problem is compounded by the time that it takes to commute to and from work, often on overcrowded public transport, which grinds to a halt at peak times. As a result, people arrive home tired, they shut the front door and soon lapse into a sedentary lifestyle of watching TV. Even children may have to face long journeys to school, getting up early and coming back exhausted late in the evening. Companies and governments could both play a part in remedying this situation. Businesses could offer job-sharing to their employees, or flexible working hours so that rush hour	the hectic pace of life: a life that is full of activity, or very busy or fast to take regular exercise: to do some physical activity on a regular basis exhausted (adjective): very tired to be detrimental to health: to be harmful to health to alleviate (verb): to make something less severe a fitness regime: a method or routine of taking regular exercise high on the agenda: something which is among the first things in the list of actions to be taken a heavy workload: a lot of work that an individual employee has to perform to compound (verb): To make something bad become even worse by causing more damage or problems to grind to a halt: to go slower and then stop completely a sedentary lifestyle: involving little exercise or physical activity to remedy (verb): to correct or improve something to job share: to share the hours of work and the pay of one job between two people
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traffic jams could be avoided. People would then have extra time and energy to do more exercise. National and local authorities should allocate resources to health awareness campaigns, in order to motivate city residents to keep fit. At the same time, funding could be provided for community sports centres in each city neighbourhood and, as in New York for example, free fitness classes in local parks. In conclusion, if city residents could spend less time on working and travelling, they could be motivated to take more exercise by accessing improved fitness amenities. 298 words	flexible working hours: hours of work that can be changed by agreement between the employer and the employee rush hour traffic jams: the time when most people are travelling to or from work/school and so there is too much traffic on the roads. national and local authorities: government organizations acting at a national level or within a smaller, local area to allocate resources to: to make money and materials available to do something health awareness campaigns: publicity to encourage people to be concerned about looking after their health. to provide funding for: to give money to enable something to be done to have access to amenities: to be able to access something, such as a swimming pool or shopping centre, that is intended to make life more pleasant or comfortable for the people in a city
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3. Some people think that good health is a basic human need, so the medical service should not be run by profit-making companies. Do you think the disadvantages of private health care outweigh the advantages?

Answer In recent years, privately-operated health services have been a popular alternative to public health care agencies. Personally, despite their	
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drawbacks, I would argue that more private medical services should be provided on the basis of their evident merits.

On the one hand, private medical treatment has its own negative impacts. The biggest drawback to private-owned hospitals is the exorbitant cost patients have to pay. When governments do not **introduce restrictions on** such costs, many private institutions set high fees for services such as **prescriptions charges** or using high-tech machines in the **operating theatre**, which effectively **discriminates against** those on low or modest incomes who cannot afford the costs for care and treatment. Additionally, as the ultimate aim of these agencies is to gain profits, it is possible that they will focus more on quantity rather than quality. With seemingly less qualified and less experienced **medical practitioners**, private hospitals might not come up to patients' expectations.

On the other hand, there are justifiable reasons why privately-run health care

to introduce restrictions on: to limit what people can do or what can happen

prescription charges: the money paid by a patient to receive medicines authorised by a doctor.

operating theatre: a room in a hospital where doctors carry out surgery on patients

to discriminate against: to treat one person or group worse than another in an unfair way

medical practitioner: a person who works as a doctor or surgeon

institutions should be made available. Firstly, they provide faster services, unlike public health services where there is often a long waiting list. Therefore, it is less time-consuming for either patients with life-threatening diseases or those coming for aregular check-up to get the treatment they want. Secondly, private healthcare institutions could be a practical alternative to state-funded ones in remote areas. If more of these agencies were established in less accessible regions, more people would be able to enjoy improved health care, especially those from minority groups who barely receive any primary health care at present. In conclusion, despite the drawbacks of medical services being provided by profit-making corporations, I believe the benefits outweigh the disadvantages and that people should take out private health insurance for better access to health care. 298 words	public health services : the agencies funded by the government to protect and promote the health of the population life-threatening conditions: illnesses which are likely to kill somebody to have a regular check-up: to have a regular examination carried out by a doctor or dentist minority groups: small groups within a community that are different because of their origin, religion, language or traditions primary health care: the medical treatment that you receive first when you are sick or ill, for example from your doctor or local clinic to take out private health insurance: to make regular payments to an insurance company, who will pay for medical or hospital treatment when you need it
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4. Today, many **children spend a lot of time playing computer games and little time on sports.** What are the **reasons** for this and is it a **positive or negative development**?

Essay: It is true that many youngsters waste <u>hours and hours</u> on computer games, <u>neglecting</u> sports and physical exercise. I believe that there is at least one important factor <u>to account for</u> this trend, which is in my opinion a totally negative one. I would argue that the marketing industry is chiefly <u>culpable</u> for the fact that a growing number of children <u>are addicted to</u> computer games. Even in developing countries, a lot of youngsters these days <u>are computer-literate</u>, and software companies know how children <u>are easily swayed by</u> the novelty of playing new games. Through their advertising, such companies aim specifically at children as their <u>target audience to promote their products</u>. These soon <u>become obsolete</u> and are replaced by new ones. As a result, children are not <u>taking up sports</u>. Instead, they find their excitement in imaginary virtual worlds of <u>gaming</u> rather than the real, physical world. The main argument against computer games is that they <u>are detrimental to</u> children's <u>health</u>. Firstly, a <u>sedentary lifestyle</u> is encouraged by playing	hours and hours: for a very long time to neglect: to fail to pay enough attention to something to account for: to be the explanation or the cause of something culpable: responsible and deserving blame for doing something wrong to be addicted (to something): to be unable to stop taking harmful drugs, tobacco or alcohol. to be computer-literate: able to use computers well to be swayed by: to be influenced to buy things target audience: consumers whom businesses aim at when selling their products to promote their products: to make products popular by advertising them to become obsolete: to be no longer used because something new has been invented to take up sport: to start doing a sport, to start doing exercise gaming: playing computer games
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computer games, whereas youngsters need <u>to take regular exercise</u>. Without sport, children may become <u>prone to obesity</u>. My cousin, for example, never plays any sports and he <u>is putting on weight</u>, mainly because of all the hours that he spends playing computer games. Secondly, too much time spent on computer games may lead to <u>social isolation</u> and resulting <u>mental health problems</u>. It might be a good idea for computer games to be sold with a warning that they carry health risks, like cigarettes or alcohol. In conclusion, advertisers are responsible for the gaming obsession of many youngsters, and I consider that this has serious negative consequences for health. 279 words	to be detrimental to health: to be harmful to health a sedentary lifestyle: involving little exercise or physical activity to take regular exercise: to start doing exercise, for example every day/every week... to be prone to obesity: to be likely to become fat [in an unhealthy way] to put on weight: to become heavier and fatter social isolation: being alone and lonely, without much contact with other people mental health problems: related to illnesses of one's mind
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5. “More and more people are becoming **seriously overweight**. Some people think a **solution** can be to **increase the price of fattening foods**. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Essay: It is true that an increasing number of people have serious weight problems. While some argue that raising the price of fattening foods might help to solve the problem, I only partly agree with this view. On the one hand, an increase in the price of fattening foods might lead to a reduction in the amount of these foods	to raise taxes on: to increase the amount of tax on something content: the amount of a substance that is contained in something else junk food: food that is quick and easy to prepare and eat, but that is thought to be bad for your health to put on weight: to become fatter and
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which people buy. Governments could raise taxes on all foods with a high fat or sugar content, because if people eat too much junk food containing a lot of fat or sugar, they will certainly put on weight and be prone to obesity. Becoming addicted to such eating habits will definitely be detrimental to their health. **For example**, this was highlighted in the film ‘Supersize Me’, in which the hero ate only at McDonald’s for a month and became very ill. Therefore, it is possible that people will buy less of this junk food if it is more expensive.

On the other hand, while price may be a factor, the problem of an increasingly overweight population also requires other solutions. **Firstly**, through health awareness campaigns, people should be encouraged to take regular exercise, because a sedentary lifestyle is definitely linked to obesity. **Secondly**, schools and workplaces could provide children and staff with a healthier diet. By preparing meals which are low in fat and high in fiber, children and employees would be much less likely to put on weight. In the UK, **for instance**, a recent campaign for healthier school meals was very successful.

In conclusion, although I believe that governments should adopt policies to increase the price of fattening food, there are also other measures which

heavier

to be prone to obesity: to be likely to become fat [in an unhealthy way]

to be addicted to something: to be unable to stop taking harmful drugs, tobacco or alcohol.

eating habits: refers to why and how people eat, which foods they eat, and with whom they eat, as well as the ways people obtain, store, use, and discard food.

to be detrimental to health: to be harmful to health

to highlight: to emphasize something, especially so that people give it more attention

health awareness campaigns: publicity to encourage people to be concerned about looking after their health.

to take regular exercise: to do some physical activity on a regular basis

a sedentary lifestyle: a type of live involving little exercise or physical activity

to provide somebody with a healthier diet: to give somebody a diet which is more healthy than that which they have at present

low in fat and high in fiber: a diet which does not contain much fat, but which contains foods which have a lot

must be taken to tackle the issue of rising obesity levels. 286 words	of fiber to put on weight: to become fatter and heavier to adopt policies: to start to use particular policies
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TỔNG HỢP BÀI MẪU CHỦ ĐỀ FOOD AND DIET by

NGOCBACH

1. **Everyone** should become **vegetarian** because they do not need to eat **meat** to have a **healthy diet**. Do you **agree or disagree**?

ANSWER:

Many people choose to become vegetarians since **a vegetarian diet** is believed to be better for **the human body**. Although I agree that eating only **plant foods** provides us with a healthier diet, I do not believe that everyone should stop eating meat in order to enjoy good health.

There are a variety of reasons why becoming a vegetarian is beneficial. Firstly, science has proven that vegetarians have lower risks of developing several **chronic illnesses** such as heart disease, **diabetes**, some forms of cancer and **obesity**. This is due to the fact that a healthy vegetarian diet is typically low in fat and **high in fiber**. Secondly, eating vegetables properly gives us adequate nutrition to support our bodies. For example, raw spinach is **a great source of** Vitamins A, K, E as well as calcium. As a result, instead of eating many kinds of food to get these vitamins, we only need a bowl of spinach.

However, there are some disadvantages to take into consideration before **becoming a vegetarian**. Perhaps the

a vegetarian diet: a diet without meat or fish.

the human body :the entire structure of all human beings is referred to commonly as ‘the human body’, even though we are referring to all humans.

plant foods: these simply refer to a number of types of food which are obtained from plants.

chronic illnesses: this is an illness which lasts for a long time and is difficult to cure.

diabetes: this is a chronic illness which makes the patient produce a lot of urine and feel thirsty.

obesity: the fact of being very fat, in an unhealthy way.

high in fiber: types of food which have a lot of fiber move other foods quickly through the human body.

a source of: a person, place or thing that you get something from. In this sentence, spinach is the plant from which you get these minerals.

becoming a vegetarian: starting to be

principal one is that if a vegetarian's daily meals are not properly balanced, he or she might suffer from a lack of calories to meet his or her energy needs. Consequently, they will feel lethargic and unable to do anything energetic. In addition, food which is eaten raw, steamed or stir-fried retains more vitamins and minerals than that which is boiled in water or deep-fried. Thus, culinary traditions such as those in Vietnam are the most advisable ones to follow in preparing vegetarian meals. Vegetarians brought up using Western cooking methods should, therefore, either change their cooking style or else adopt a non-vegetarian diet. In conclusion, although healthy, a vegetarian diet is not for everyone and it requires care in the choice of foods and preparation of meals.	a vegetarian. balanced: having different types of things in the correct amounts. So, in this sentence a vegetarian diet must have different types of food in the right quantities to ensure good health. energetic: the examiner is often impressed by your ability to use energy/energetic or other noun/adjective/adverb/verb vocabulary. In the same way, the examiner is impressed by your knowledge and use of suffixes and prefixes. steamed: food which is steamed is cooked in the vapour which is produced when water boils. So, the food is not in contact with the boiling water and it keeps more minerals and vitamins. stir-fried and deep-fried: when food is stir-fried, it is cooked very quickly in a little oil in a shallow cooking pan, called a wok in China. In contrast, deep-fried food, such as chips, means that the food is completely covered by oil in a deep pan and the cooking time is longer. adopt a non-vegetarian diet: to use a different type of diet.
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2. In many countries, more and more people choose to buy **imported food** rather than **food produced locally**. **Why** do people buy imported food? **What could be done** to encourage people to buy local food?

Amended essay:

It is true that the consumption of imported food has increased in recent years. There are some factors which help to **account for** this trend, but measures can be implemented to encourage more people to eat food which is grown locally.

In many countries, people are buying more imported food and there are a number of reasons to explain why this is happening. Firstly, the attractive **marketing** and presentation of imported food products gives them an appealing and **appetizing** appearance. Consumers then **come to** expect certain high standards of **packaging**, so that food looks tasty, safe, hygienic and – in the case of some products – easy to prepare. Secondly, the **availability** of a wide range of imported food enables people to vary their diet and experiment with new recipes. This may **provide a welcome change** from eating the same meals every day, which inevitably becomes tedious and no longer stimulates the **taste buds**.

It is possible, however, to take steps to encourage the consumption of locally produced food. Local growers should ensure that their products always look clean and fresh. In Vietnam, for example, all the fruit and vegetables, meat and fish on display at local markets must be presented in **scrupulously** hygienic conditions,

account for: to be the explanation or cause of something

marketing: the activity of presenting and selling goods in an attractive way

appetizing: smelling or looking attractive, so that you feel hungry or thirsty

come to: to become accustomed to a particular situation

packaging: materials used to wrap or protect goods sold in shops

availability: the fact that something is possible to get or to buy

provide a welcome change: offer a change which you like and are happy to accept

taste buds: small structures in your mouth which allow you to recognise the flavours of food or drink

scrupulously: with great care and

protected by plastic wrapping to keep away dust or flies. Government should enforce strict food safety regulations. Another measure could be to increase the variety of food produced by local farmers, which would then eliminate the need to import those foods from other countries. This would stimulate the local economy and reduce the environmental costs of transportation known as food miles. In conclusion, while are some obvious reasons to explain the rise in popularity of imported food, some simple measures should be adopted by local food growers to meet this challenge. 294 words	attention to every detail wrapping: the paper, plastic or other material used to cover something in order to protect it eliminate: to remove or get rid of something food miles: (đường đi của thực phẩm) the distance that food has to travel from the producer to the consumer and the fuel that this uses meet a challenge: deal with a new and difficult task successfully
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TỔNG HỢP BÀI MẪU CHỦ ĐỀ GOVERNMENT BY NGOCBACH

1. Nowadays more and more **young people** hold the **important positions** in the **government**. Some people think that is a **good** thing while others argue that it is **not suitable**. **Discuss both views** and give **your own opinion**.

ANSWER:

It is true that the number of young people who hold highly responsible posts in the government is growing. While some people are opposed to this idea, I support the view that this trend is beneficial at present.

On the one hand, this trend has some **notable drawbacks**. [1] The main issue is that it is really hard for the young to make older people accept their leadership, especially in some Eastern nations. Young leaders are always thought to have insufficient capabilities to manage such aspects of policy as the economy or international affairs. [2] In addition, all of them are short of real experience. If they have not **faced many challenges** in their career, they are more likely to make mistakes, which can affect the lives of many people.

On the other hand, it seems to me that young people are becoming an increasingly important part of the government and bring a lot of benefits. [1] One reason is that their youth is a

notable drawbacks= disadvantages which are important to note.

faced many challenges= had to deal with many difficult problems and overcome them.

huge advantage which allows them to be creative and up-to-date. This is likely to result in many innovative breakthrough policies and styles of management. [2] Furthermore, the young have a very long period of time to contribute to their nations. For example, with the same abilities and qualifications, a younger candidate is more likely to be elected than an older counterpart in some countries because of his longer anticipated time of devotion to public service in the future. In conclusion, although there are strong arguments for both views, it seems to me that on the whole it is beneficial that more young people are being selected to play some key roles in the government. 276 words	creative and up-to-date= using skill and imagination to produce something new and modern. innovative breakthrough policies= policies which are new and revolutionary different from previous policies. counterpart= a person [or thing] which has the same position or function as someone [or something] else in a different place or situation. devotion to public service= to give a lot of time and effort to serving the community when working for an official or government organisation.
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2. In many countries, **governments** are spending **a large amount of money on improving internet access**. **Why** is it happening and do you think it is the most **appropriate use of government money**?

Essay: It is true that in many countries, governments are investing heavily in extending internet access. While this policy can be defended on a number of grounds, I would argue that there are more urgent priorities which require	investing heavily: investing a lot of money in something.
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public funding.

There are important factors which explain why some governments are **devoting** significant funds to the improvement of internet access.

Firstly, if more and more citizens are able to access the wealth of information available online, the result will be a population that is better informed and more highly educated.

Online news and courses will eventually become available to everyone, and the possibilities of extending **distance learning** offer exciting opportunities for the younger generation in particular. Secondly, authorities have recognised the power of the internet in terms of providing a **medium** for **running campaigns** on a range of issues. Among these issues, governments have provided online help and advice on such things as disease prevention, **food hygiene** and road safety.

However, I believe that there are more **pressing issues** which call for immediate government financial assistance. From an educational perspective, in many developing countries, rural communities and **impoverished** districts of cities require more schools and colleges, **staffed** by capable teachers and administrators. An educated workforce, vital to national prosperity, will be the product of investment in education. From the

devote to: give an amount of money or time to something

distance learning: a system of education in which people study at home with the help of internet sites and e-mail work to their teachers.

medium: a way of communicating information to people.

run campaigns: conduct campaigns.

food hygiene: the clean and safe preparation of food.

pressing issues: problems which need immediate attention.

impoverished: poor.

perspective of national security, the safety of all citizens depends on government expenditure on police and security services. The increase in terrorist incidents, such as the recent attacks in France, has resulted in the loss of many innocent lives. In conclusion, although there are sound reasons why public authorities should want to invest in improving internet access, I consider that there are more important problems which demand government funding. 285 words	staff: people work in a company or organisation terrorist incidents: violent attacks conducted by terrorists. sound reasons: good and sensible reasons.
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3. It is **impossible** to **help all people in the world**, so **governments** should only focus on **people in their own countries**. To what extent do you **agree or disagree**?

ANSWER Some people consider that helping all needy people all around the world would be an impossible ideal, and therefore governments should only be concerned about those who live in their own countries. I completely disagree with this view. One reason is that it is now possible to provide international aid quickly and efficiently. Modern means of transport enable government agencies to provide aid within hours to even relatively remote corners of the world. There have been numerous recent examples	needy: not having enough money, food, clothes....
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of how such government assistance has **alleviated** suffering and saved lives. The recent **tsunami** in Japan left tens of thousands of people **homeless** and in desperate need of food and shelter, but the reponse of governments around the world was immediate. Very quickly, supplies of food and **tents** arrived by air, along with medical staff and **vaccines**.

Another reason is that I consider that we share a moral responsibility to help all those who lack the **basic necessities** of life. These needs have no geographical boundaries and national governments should recognise their international **obligations**. It is not enough to place responsibility only on charities and international relief organisations like UNICEF or the Red Cross. Such organisations accept that we share **a common humanity**, and the **sufferings** of no individual should be ignored anywhere in the world. Governments must not only provide international assistance as part of their budget, but must also provide money for international aid bodies.

In conclusion, although of course governments must tackle urgent problems at home, they have the means and the moral responsibility to fulfil their international obligations to everyone in need.

279 words.

remote corners of the world: places in the world which are difficult to access because of distance or difficulties of transport to get there.

alleviated: made something less severe.

tsunami: a very large wave in the sea cause, for example, by an earthquake.

homeless: having no home.

tents: shelters supported by ropes and fixed to the ground, used for camping or to provide temporary shelter.

vaccines: substances that are put into the blood to protect someone from disease.

basic necessities: the things which we must have and cannot survive without.

obligations: things which you must do, because of the law or because you have promised.

	a common humanity: the quality of being a person, rather than a machine, a god or an animal. sufferings: feelings of pain and unhappiness.
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4. Some people believe that people have the right to university education, and **government** should make it **free no matter what their financial background**. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

ANSWER It is true that some people argue for the universal right to free university education. While this ideal is a worthy aim, I believe that it is impractical for governments to implement such a policy. On the one hand, it is not a utopian dream to expect government authorities to fund higher education for those poorer sections of society, with low incomes and no savings. Without such funding, people from poor backgrounds would be unable to attend university. As a consequence, they would be excluded from many well-paid careers as engineers, doctors or lawyers. Social inequalities would be perpetuated and society as a whole would suffer, since those from low-income backgrounds would have no opportunity to develop their talents. The example of the US, during the struggle for civil rights for blacks and other minorities, shows the folly of denying equal educational	universal: involving all the people in the world worthy: having good qualities that deserve your respect utopian: having a strong, but not practical, belief that everything can be perfect fund: to provide money for something official savings: money that you have saved, especially in a bank exclude: to prevent somebody from taking part or joining something perpetuate: to make something last for a long time, for example an idea or a bad situation background: the details of a person's family, education, wealth.... folly: a lack of good judgement or the
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opportunities for the poor. On the other hand, there would be an enormous strain on government budgets if free access to university were a right for everyone. At its simplest, people from rich families can afford to pay tuition fees and for their own maintenance during their studies. Attendance at university is a privilege, not a right, and if students can afford to pay for their studies, they should do so. In practical terms, governments cannot pay for the rich as well as the poor. Governments are faced with practical decisions on how to allocate their finite budgets, and funding free higher education for everyone would mean less money to spend on pressing issues such as health care or the environment. In conclusion, I disagree with the view that free higher education should be a right for everyone in society, and funding should be limited to those who otherwise could not afford to attend university. 297 words	fact of doing something stupid strain: pressure on somebody or something maintenance: the things that you need in order to live – food, housing, clothes.... privilege: something that you are fortunate to have the chance to do allocate: to give something to somebody for a specific purpose finite: having a definite limit
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5. **Scientific research** should be **carried out** and **controlled** by the **governments** rather than **private companies**. Do you agree or disagree?

Essay: At present, scientific research across the world is carried out and controlled sometimes by governments, sometimes	
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by private companies. While there are some arguments in favour of scientific research by corporations, I agree with the view that this should be funded and supervised by the state.

The private sector argues that it is willing to undertake scientific research, but there are two significant dangers in this. In terms of the quality and objectivity of the research itself, corporations which carry this out may be tempted to manipulate results in order to **maximize profits**. There have been numerous scandals as a result of new products being introduced hurriedly after inadequate trials. For example thalidomide, developed by a German drug company, resulted in the birth of thousands of malformed children. From an ethical perspective, leaving research into areas such as **genetic engineering** in the hands of corporations may have profound social consequences –such as **GM crops**, with **unproven effects** which may **destroy whole ecosystems** as a result of **meddling with nature**.

Although governments have **to allocate resources to** many areas of public spending, it is essential that they be responsible for scientific research. Firstly, the highest standards can be set by **providing funding for** university departments to carry out high-quality research designed to benefit society,

to maximize profits: to increase profits to the highest possible level

genetic engineering: the science of changing how a living creature or plant develops by changing the information in its genes.

genetically-modified (GM) crops: plants used in agriculture, the DNA of which has been changed by using genetic engineering techniques.

unproven effects: effects which have not been tested or shown to be true

to damage ecosystems: to harm the physical environment in which all the plants and animals living in a particular area are able to survive.

not to break into new markets or to gain a competitive edge. Knowledge thus gained can be shared worldwide throughout the academic community. Secondly, government-decision making is the best way to prioritize expenditure on specific areas of research, taking into consideration the needs of society, both present and future. One example is the development of renewable energy to meet growing demands. In conclusion, I agree strongly with the view that governments should bear sole responsibility for scientific research. 291 words	to meddle with nature: to try to change or to have an influence on the environment, especially by acting in a way that is not scientific. to allocate resources to: to make money and materials available to do something. to provide funding for: to give money to enable something to be done to break into new markets: to enter new markets that are difficult to enter to gain a competitive edge: to achieve an advantage over another company or organization, often by providing goods or services at a lower price. government decision-making: the process of deciding about something official to prioritize expenditure on: to put the need to spend money on certain things first. renewable energy: energy is renewable when its source, like the sun or wind, cannot be exhausted or can easily be replaced (like wood, as we can plant trees for energy).
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6. Nowadays, many people **cannot read or write**. What problems does this cause? What measures can governments take to solve these problems?

Essay:

It is true that even today, illiteracy is widespread. **While** this presents serious difficulties for individuals and society, there are steps that governments should take to deal with the problem.

When people can neither read nor write, they are disadvantaged in important ways. **In terms of** the individual consequences of illiteracy, dealing with bureaucracy is a nightmare. Reading and writing – or even adding a signature to – an official document is often necessary, **for example** when people have to apply for social welfare benefits. From the perspective of society in general, it is difficult to integrate economic migrants into society who are perhaps illiterate in their home countries, or are unable to read and write in the language of the host country. This makes the task of constructing a multicultural society difficult if minority groups are forced to do sweated labour, simply because they are illiterate and excluded from better-paid jobs.

There are, however, policies which national and local authorities can adopt to improve matters. **Firstly**, resources should be allocated to provide basic literacy classes in local colleges or

illiteracy: the fact of not knowing how to read or write

disadvantaged : not having things, such as education or enough money, that people need in order to have a good life

bureaucracy : the system of complicated official rules or ways of doing things organised by a government

nightmare : a dream, or an experience, that is very frightening or unpleasant

welfare : practical or financial help provided by the government to help people in need

to integrate into society: to become accepted as a member of a social group, especially when a person comes from a different culture

economic migrants: people who move from their own countries to a new country in order to find work or to have a better standard of living

a multicultural society: a society which includes people of different

social and community centres to help people to learn to read and write. **Secondly**, government departments must employ staff who have specific responsibility for helping illiterate people to cope with the confusing mass of official paperwork. In this way, they will not be discriminated against, **for instance** by losing welfare rights to which they are entitled. **Finally**, governments even in developing countries must ensure that everyone has the right to a basic education which enables them to read and write.

In conclusion, although illiteracy is a serious problem, there are steps which governments should take to help those who can neither read nor write.

282 words

origins, traditions and languages

minority groups: small groups within a community that are different because of their origin, religion, language or traditions

sweated labour: hard work that is done for low wages in poor conditions; the people who do this work

to adopt policies: to start to use particular policies

national and local authorities: government organizations acting at a national level or within a smaller, local area

to allocate resources to: to make money and materials available to do something

social and community centres: places where people who live in the same area can meet for events or to do different activities

to cope with : to deal successfully with something difficult

paperwork : the written work that is part of a job, such as filling in forms or writing reports or letters

to discriminate: to treat one person or group worse/better than another in an unfair way

7. *In many cities there is little control on the design and construction of new homes and office buildings, and people can build houses in their own style. What are the advantages and disadvantages of such a situation?*

Essay: It is true that <u>national and local authorities</u> in some cities around the world fail <u>to introduce restrictions on planning</u>. While this allows great freedom of choice for <u>property developers</u> and individual homeowners, I believe that the disadvantages outweigh such benefits. On the one hand, uncontrolled construction of housing and offices encourages investment in a city. If there are few planning regulations <u>to adhere to</u>, investors are more likely <u>to speculate</u> on increasing <u>the housing stock</u>, often using the most <u>cost-effective</u> designs. With more available housing, there should be fewer people <u>living on the streets</u>. In terms of the construction of office buildings, without controls on the provision of <u>high-rise buildings</u>, a huge amount of space can be made available for companies to locate in a particular city. This might potentially increase employment opportunities in the area. On the other hand, there are major drawbacks when urban development is unplanned in this way. Firstly, <u>urban sprawl</u> is encouraged, and this is an undesirable feature of many modern cities. In some US cities, for example, <u>sprawling suburbs</u> have <u>sprung up</u> while	national and local authorities: government organizations acting at a national level or within a smaller, local area to introduce restrictions on: to limit what people can do or what can happen a property developer: a person who buys land or buildings, and then makes improvements in order to sell them for more money to adhere to: to limit what people can do or what can happen to speculate: to buy a house or other property, hoping to make a profit when you sell it, but with the risk of losing money the housing stock: all the houses available for living in cost-effective: giving the best possible benefits or profits in comparison with the money that is spent to be living on the streets: to be without a place in which to live high-rise buildings: tall modern buildings (not as tall as skyscrapers) urban sprawl: a large area covered with buildings that spreads from the city into the countryside in an ugly way sprawling suburbs: an area outside of the centre of a city where people live, but which is spreading without control into the
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at the same time <u>slum areas</u> and <u>sink estates</u> have been allowed to decay in <u>the inner city areas</u>. Secondly, when individuals can put up buildings to any design which they want, the result is that the city simply <u>becomes an eyesore</u>. Buildings may simply not <u>blend in with</u> each other. For instance, <u>towering skyscrapers</u> may be constructed next to <u>famous landmarks</u>, completely <u>overshadowing</u> them. In conclusion, I would argue that the unplanned growth of cities has produced both ugliness and <u>chaos</u>. Such drawbacks greatly outweigh any benefits. 268 words	surrounding countryside to spring up: to appear or develop quickly or suddenly slum areas: parts of a city where the houses are poor and the houses are dirty and in bad condition sink estates: housing located in a poor area of a city where social conditions are bad inner city areas: the parts near the centre of a city, which often have social problems to be an eyesore: to be ugly to look at towering skyscrapers: very tall modern buildings, usually in a city a famous landmark: a building that is very important because of its historical or modern significance to blend in (with something): If something blends in, then it is similar to - or matches - its surroundings to overshadow: to make something (or somebody) seem less important chaos: a state of complete confusion and lack of order
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8. Government should invest in teaching science subjects rather than other subjects in order for a country to develop and progress. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Essay: It is true that investment in science education in schools and universities should <u>be high on the agenda</u> of all governments. However, while this is important, I disagree that this should be the only priority, because it is also	high on the agenda: something which is among the first things in the list of actions to be taken to allocate resources to: to make money and materials available to do
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important <u>to allocate resources to</u> the teaching of other subjects. It is clearly essential <u>to provide funding for</u> the study of science subjects. Recent discoveries in science <u>have been applied to</u> bring about changes in such fields as health, food production and, above all, communications. For example, genetics based on the research of biologists is <u>revolutionising</u> the treatment of diseases such as cancer. Therefore, governments must invest heavily in science subjects in order to ensure that the knowledge of science graduates is <u>up-to-date</u>. If this is done, the international scientific community will, for instance, be able to find solutions to <u>pressing</u> environmental challenges facing the world today. However, government investment in science education must not be at the expense of <u>neglecting</u> other subjects. Progress and development do not mean economic growth. Firstly, schools should encourage students <u>to express themselves</u> through art, literature and music and develop those talents which are a part of our cultural life. Secondly, if it were not for the study of subjects such as history, philosophy and languages, then nobody would be able <u>to see the big picture</u>. Ethical social questions concerning how people might <u>live in harmony with one another</u> in a sustainable way would	something to provide funding for: to give money to enable something to be done to apply something to something: to use something or make something work in a particular situation to revolutionise/revolutionize: to completely change the way that something is done. up-to-date: modern, fashionable pressing: needing to be dealt with immediately to neglect: to not give enough attention to something to express oneself: to communicate some idea or emotion through speech, writing, painting, music or some other form of art to see the big picture: to understand all the important aspects of a situation to live in harmony with one another: to live with others in a way which avoids conflict or disagreement
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never be discussed. In conclusion, it is necessary for governments to invest in science education, but they must also promote the study of other subjects to develop the creativity and critical thinking of students. 273 words	
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TỔNG HỢP BÀI MẪU CHỦ ĐỀ FAMILY AND CHILDREN by NGOCBACH

1. Nowadays, more and more **people** decide to **have children later in their life**. What are the **reasons**? What are the **effects** on **society** and **family life**?

Essay:

In recent years, the decision of parents **to start a family later in life** has become an **increasingly popular trend**. There are a number of reasons for this trend, which is **having a significant impact on** both family life and on the **community as a whole**.

There are two important reasons why more people nowadays are **deciding against** having children when they are young. Firstly, rather than **embarking on parenthood**, many individuals consider that building their own successful careers is **top-priority**. If they had to **split their time between** working and **bringing up their offspring** when they were **in the early stages of** their careers, their performance at work and **promotion prospects** could be negatively affected. Secondly, **delaying childbirth** could give young people **countless opportunities** to enjoy their lives. For

to start a family later in life: to begin a family later rather than earlier

increasingly popular trend: something is being done by more and more people at this time

having a significant impact on: to affect something in some way, either positively or negatively

community as a whole: a community is a group of people

deciding against: to make a decision not in favor of something

embarking on parenthood: to become a parent; parenthood refers to the time you spend raising them

top-priority: the thing you want to do the most, above everything else

to split their time between: to spend some of your time doing one thing and some of your time doing another thing

bringing up one's offspring: to raise one's children (to educate, nurture them, etc)

promotion prospects: chances an

example, this choice may let young couples have a richer social life, pursue their interests and hobbies or even to travel the world. However, this tendency could have negative consequences in terms of both family life and society. An important concern for a family is that raising children could be a huge challenge for older parents. Even though they might have a high socioeconomic status, as well as great experience and knowledge, it may not be easy for them to communicate with and relate to their children, due to the generation gap. Another negative factor is that getting pregnant after 35 years of age oftentimes carries more potential health risks. Specifically, this could increase the danger of having a miscarriage or stillbirth for older mothers, and babies might be at greater risk of having Down's syndrome. Consequently, this could negatively affect the quality of the future workforce. In conclusion, there are a number of	employee has for gaining a better position countless: too many to be counted tendency: an inclination toward a particular characteristic or type of behavior huge challenge: a tough or difficult challenge high socioeconomic status: your socioeconomic status refers to how much money you have and therefore your status or place in society; if it's high, it means you have a lot of money relate to: show a connection between generation gap: differences of outlook or opinion between people of different generations negative factor: something that you have to consider because it might not be good oftentimes carries more potential health risks: oftentimes just means often or many times; to carry more potential risk means that it is possible to have health problems because of something having a miscarriage: this is what happens when a woman does not carry the fetus to full term
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reasons why more and more people prefer giving birth later in life. As a result, there could be negative influences on individual families and the society at large. 312 words	Down's syndrome: a genetic chromosome 21 disorder causing developmental and intellectual delays Consequently: used to say something that happens because of something else future workforce: refers to the fact that young people will be workers in the future negative influences on individual families: bad effects on nuclear families consisting of a couple and their children the society at large: people in general; the community as a whole
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2. In **recent** years, the **family structure** has **changed**, as well as **family roles**. **What** are the **changes** which have occurred? Do you think these changes are **positive or negative**?

Essay: It is true that modern life has brought about a number of significant changes in terms of the family structure and the roles of family members. There are some important changes that have taken place, and in my opinion these have been largely positive Some traditional family roles and structures have now become a thing of the past. Perhaps the most important revolution has been the increasing trend for women to pursue careers,	brought about: made something happen. a thing of the past: something that no longer happens or exists.
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even when they are married. As a result, in many households, husbands now help their wives to do the **chores** which were once considered ‘women’s work’. The tendency to pursue a career has also had another effect, as couples put their studies and work first before marriage and before having children. Previous generations in Vietnam, for example, would have considered such arrangements as unusual, especially in the case of women.

I consider such developments as positive, despite the objections raised by **traditionalists**. Firstly, in the modern **nuclear family**, children learn to become independent at an earlier age. **Kindergartens** and **nursery schools** offer places for children to play and learn to **socialise**, enabling **working parents** to earn enough money for the family to enjoy a high standard of living. Secondly, parents of small families with a **double income** can invest more in the education and well-being of their children. Consequently, the **life chances and choices** of those children will be improved if there is enough money to finance later university studies, and gain essential qualifications to **make their way** in the modern **world of work**.

In conclusion, while it may be fashionable to **mourn** the loss of the traditional family, it is more **realistic** to

chores: a job that is often boring but has to be done regularly.

traditionalists: people who believe in the old, traditional ideas.

nuclear family: a family that consists of only a father, mother and their children.

kindergartens and nursery schools: schools for children between the ages of 2 and 5.

socialise: meet and spend time with other people [in this case, other children] in a friendly way and enjoy yourself.

working parents: parents who both go out to work.

double income: two salaries.

life chances and choices: the opportunities for each individual to improve his or her quality of life and to choose the things that they want to do.

welcome the changes that have taken place as positive, to meet the challenges of the modern world. 290 words	make their way: achieve success in life. world of work: you can use ‘world’ to refer to a particular activity and the people involved in it. mourn: feel sad because something or somebody no longer exists. realistic: sensible and appropriate.
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3. High school students are usually not good at managing money. What are the reasons? What are the solutions?

Essay:

It is true that high school students are not renowned for their skills in managing their own finances. Two factors stand out as being responsible for this failing, but there are steps which can be taken to remedy the problem. High school students are often incapable of managing money for two main reasons. The first is family background. During their formative years, children of high school age are often rebellious, asserting their independence as they prepare to enter adult life. They may say that parents are being overprotective when giving advice about money matters. Secondly, adolescents are very impressionable. They are easily swayed by advertisements, and the media	to be renowned for: to be famous for something good failing: a defect in character, conduct, or ability family background: the details of a person’s family formative years: a period of a person’s life, usually childhood, that has a big influence on the person they become later in life rebellious: showing a desire to resist authority, control, or convention to enter adult life: to become a grown-
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skilfully employs **market research** to persuade teenage consumers **to buy particular goods impulsively**. So, regardless of the cost, high school students sometimes borrow on credit to spend on ‘must have’ items, such as designer label clothes or the latest i-Pod.

There are measures which parents and the authorities should take to deal with this issue. From an early age, parents ought to bring up their children **to make the most of** their **pocket money**. Parents must encourage **patterns of behaviour** in which youngsters learn to use money wisely and not **to squander their savings** in order to keep up with their peers in school. Government, as well as **parental involvement**, also has a role to play. Controls must be placed on how the media operates, particularly in the booming field of **online advertising**. **Celebrity endorsement** should be banned, as young people of high school age are vulnerable to the association of certain products with glamour and success.

In conclusion, persuading high school students to manage their money wisely is not an easy task for the reasons explained, but parents and government can implement some **common-sense** solutions.

293 words.

up person

overprotective: tend to protect someone excessively

impressionable: easily influenced due to a lack of critical ability

to be swayed by advertisements: to be influenced to buy things as a result of advertising

market research: the action or activity of gathering information about consumers' needs and preferences

to buy goods impulsively: to buy things suddenly without any planning and without considering the effects they may have

to make the most of sth: to get as much out of something as is possible

patterns of behavior: ways of acting and doing things (either positive or negative)

to squander one's savings: to spend one's savings extravagantly, thoughtlessly, or wastefully

	parental involvement: the act or process of parents when taking part in their children's activities. online advertising: a form of marketing and advertising which uses the Internet to deliver promotional marketing messages to consumers celebrity endorsement: a form of brand or advertising campaign that involves a well known person using their fame to help promote a product common-sense: to be able to use good <u>judgment</u> in making <u>decisions</u> and to <u>live</u> in <u>areasonable</u> and <u>safe</u> way
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4. The best way to reduce youth crime is to educate their parents with parental skills. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Essay:

It is true that parents should play a significant role in reducing youth crime by bringing up their children to be law-abiding citizens. However, I disagree that educating parents on how to raise their children is the most effective way to reduce juvenile crime. Counselling in parental skills would reduce youth crime. Family	law-abiding citizens: people who respect and obey the la family background: the details of a person's family
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background is an important influence in **shaping a child's personality**, and **parental involvement** is essential in teaching children the right moral values. While advice on parenting skills should be given to parents, it is not practical to extend this to every family. **Local authorities** which provide **social services** must provide some form of counselling to **single parent households, dysfunctional families** or to parents in homes where there is **domestic violence**. Parenting advice should be incorporated into a package of assistance to such families in all countries where a **welfare state** exists. If parents are educated to have a **social conscience**, then they will be more aware of the dangers of allowing their adolescent children **to turn to crime or drugs**.

Strict **law enforcement** is, however, the most effective means to reduce youth crime. Judges and magistrates must **be tough on crime** and should apply **the letter of the law** when juvenile offenders come before the courts. The punishments imposed on youths who break the law must **act as a deterrent** against re-offending. Youths should **serve prison sentences** when they commit serious offences, and there are other effective **non-custodial sentences** which could be imposed. In the UK, for example, youngsters are sometimes **put on probation** or given a chance of **reintegrating back into society** through performing some

to shape a child's personality: to decide or influence the form of a child's personality

parental involvement: the act or process of parents when taking part in their children's activities.

local authorities: government organizations acting within a local area

social services: a system that is organized by the government to help people who have financial or family problems; the department or the people who provide this help.

domestic violence: violence among family members in the home

a welfare state: a taxation system which allows governments to provide for the economic and social well-being of its citizens

a social conscience: the state of being aware of the problems that affect a lot of people in society, such as being poor or having no home, and wanting to do something to help these people

to turn to crime or drugs: to start committing crimes or using drugs.

to enforce the law: to make sure that the law is obeyed

community service. In conclusion, though teaching parental skills would help to reduce youth crime, a policy of harsh sentencing is the most effective measure. 293 words	to be tough on crime: to punish crime severely the letter of the law: the exact wording of the law, without considering any excuses to act as a deterrent: a measure which makes somebody less likely to do something to serve a prison sentence: to carry out confinement in prison as a punishment a non-custodial sentence: a sentence which is not served in prison to put on probation: to make a convicted person see an official at regular intervals to check on their good behavior, as an alternative to going to prison to reintegrate back into society: to restore someone through education or therapy a dysfunctional family: a family in which the relationships are bad or unhealthy a single parent household: a family in which one person takes care of their child or children without a husband, wife or partner.
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5. People in many countries have to spend more and more time away from their home. Why is this? What are the effects on people themselves and their families?

Essay:

It is true that in many countries a feature of modern life is that people tend to spend more time away from home. While some reasons can be identified to explain this trend, the effects on individuals and their families must be considered as largely negative.

There are two very important factors that influence many people to be away from home for longer. Firstly, contemporary economic realities have transformed men's working lives. One **inevitable consequence** of the new global economy is **the disappearance of traditional ways of life**, so that individuals now have to seek **far and wide** to find work **to support their family** or to improve their **job prospects**. Secondly, in the search for a better standard of living, women are abandoning traditional **patterns of behaviour**, so that **dual-income families** and **working mothers** are becoming **the norm**. The family in which the mother stayed at home to look after the children **is incompatible with** modern **aspirations** for a better lifestyle, which can only be achieved by working longer hours.

Both factors have important consequences for individuals and their families. Men who move away to work in another city, or even another

an inevitable consequence: certain to happen and unable to be avoided or prevented

the disappearance of traditional ways of life: the fact that traditional ways no longer

far and wide (expression): over a large area

to support a family: to have enough money to be able to look after a family

job prospects: the chances of being successful and having more opportunities at work

patterns of behaviour: ways of acting and doing things (either positive or negative)

a dual-income family: a family where both the father and mother work

country, often become **economic migrants**, labouring for a **minimum wage** or being forced to accept conditions of **sweated labour**. Although they may work to send money home to their families, like many **guest workers** in the UK or Germany, the **ties of kinship** with their families are weakened. Women who go out to work full-time have less influence in **shaping their children's personality** during a child's **formative years**. As a result, children may develop behavioural problems in the future.

In conclusion, some reasons for this trend can readily be identified, and the consequences are **far-reaching** for individuals and their families.

293 words

working mothers: women who have a job and also have to take care of their children

the norm (noun): a situation or pattern of behaviour that is usual or expected.

to be incompatible with: not able to exist or work with another person or thing because of basic differences

aspiration (noun): a strong desire to have or do something.

economic migrants: people who move from their own countries to a new country in order to find work or to have a better standard of living

minimum wage: the lowest wage that an employer is allowed to pay by law

sweated labour: hard work that is done for low wages in poor conditions; the people who do this work

guest workers (noun): people, usually from a poor country, who go to another richer country to work there

ties of kinship: the fact of being related in a family, with links of friendship and assistance to other

	family members to shape a child's personality: to decide or influence the form of a child's personality formative years: a period of a person's life, usually childhood, that has a big influence on the person they become later in life far-reaching (adjective): likely to have a lot of influence or many effects
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6. Some people say that nowadays children have too much freedom. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Essay:

Some people believe that nowadays youngsters have too much licence to behave how they like. I totally agree with this view, because I think that more discipline should be imposed for the benefit and protection of children at school and in the home. There are dangers in the current tendency in many schools to allow children to have too much freedom. While some traditional ideas of schooling have been dismissed, such as harsh corporal punishment, not all change is for the better. When the authority of the teacher is	to impose discipline: to make students obey the rules of the school or college
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undermined, then no learning takes place in the classroom. **Lessons are sometimes disrupted** by students shouting, running around or playing with their mobile phones. Unpunished, pupils **fall behind with their studies** and fail **to make the grade** when they **sit exams**. Therefore, to maintain educational standards, the schoolchildren of today should be given less freedom to behave as they like.

In the home, **parental involvement** is often too **lax** in the upbringing of children. Without this supervision, children nowadays easily fall into juvenile crime and anti-social behaviour, or are **preyed on** by evil people on social networking sites. All these are major issues, for example, in UK society. In the past, many parents **may have been overprotective**, but today's children are too often allowed to spend money and time unsupervised. Although I agree that youngsters should be allowed some freedom of choice during their **formative years**, strict rules are lacking at home. Too few parents impose responsible **patterns of behaviour** such as regular bedtimes, times for homework and the need for children to inform parents of where they and what they are doing.

In conclusion, children today have been given too much freedom to behave as they like at school and in the

to dismiss traditional ideas: to decide that traditional ideas are not important and not worth considering anymore

to be for the better: to improve a situation

to undermine : to make something, especially somebody's confidence or authority, weaker or less effective

to disrupt lessons: to make it difficult to conduct the lesson in the normal way

to fall behind with their studies: to improve more slowly in studying than other people so that you fail to learn the course material at the necessary speed

to make the grade: To successfully reach the necessary standard

to sit an exam: to take an exam

parental involvement: the act or process of parents when taking part in their children's activities.

lax : not strict enough about standards of behaviour or rules

home. 293 words.	to prey on [phrasal verb]: to harm somebody who is weaker than you, or to use them in a dishonest way to get what you want to be overprotective: to be too worried about the safety of someone, especially a child formative years: A period of a person's life, usually childhood, that has a big influence on the person they become later in life patterns of behaviour: ways of acting and doing things (either positive or negative)
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7. The tradition that the family gets together to eat meals is disappearing. What are the reasons? What are the impacts?

Essay: It is true that the traditional family mealtime is becoming a thing of the past. There are some reasons which	patterns of behaviour: ways of acting and doing things (either positive or negative).
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can be put forward to explain this changing **pattern of behaviour**, and there are significant impacts on family life and health.

There are two obvious reasons why families no longer share mealtimes as they used to do in the past. Firstly, children are often too impatient to eat at the table, and parents sometimes allow them to have their meal in front of the TV or sitting in front of the computer. Secondly, the **close-knit family** is disappearing in the face of economic pressures. In **single-parent households**, or in families with **working mothers**, it can be almost impossible to arrange regular times for meals when all the family is together.

The consequences for family life and for children's health are serious. From the perspective of the family, meals taken together are an important feature of a stable **family background**. This stability of family routine is a essential factor in **shaping children's personality** during their **formative years**. Family mealtimes are a time to share news, give guidance and to make plans together. In terms of children's health, family meals were an opportunity **to provide all the family members with a healthier diet**, based on wholesome **home-made food**. Without this routine, children are sometimes left **to have snacks**, or to eat **junk food** at **fast food chains**. Health consequences such as obesity

a close-knit family: a family having strong relationships with each other, helping with problems and enjoying a lot of time together.

a single-parent household: a family in which one parent takes care of the children without the help of a husband, wife or partner.

working mothers: women who have a job and also have to take care of their children.

family background: the details of a person's family life

to shape a child's personality: to decide or influence the form of a child's personality.

formative years: A period of a person's life, usually childhood, that has a big influence on the person that they become later in life.

to provide somebody with a healthier diet: to give somebody a diet which is more healthy than that which they have at present.

and **hyperactivity** often result when youngsters fail **to eat a balanced diet**, such as used to be provided at family mealtimes.

In conclusion, some reasons can be identified for the decline in shared family meals and the impacts are **overwhelmingly** negative.

281 words.

home-made food: food which is prepared at home using individual ingredients.

to have a snack: to eat a small amount of food between main meals.

junk food: food that is quick and easy to prepare and eat, but that is thought to be bad for your health.

fast food chains: groups of shops owned by the same company, serving food to the public.

to eat a balanced diet: to eat the correct types and amounts of food.

hyperactivity (noun): a state in which a person, usually a child, is only able to keep quiet and still for a short period.

overwhelmingly (adverb): in a way that is very great or very strong.

8. For **school children**, their **teachers have more influence on their intelligence and social development** than their **parents**. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Essay:

It is true that school children are at an impressionable age, and two strong influences on their intelligence and social development are teachers and parents. **While I accept that** teachers may have more influence on the intelligence of their pupils, I would argue that parents probably exert a greater influence on the social development of their children.

In terms of encouraging the intellectual development and stimulating the intelligence of school children, I believe that teachers play the major role. While not all teachers are capable of inspiring their students, they are trained to impart their knowledge of their subject areas in challenging and imaginative ways. **For example**, some students owe their lifelong love of a subject to dedicated teachers who taught this discipline in secondary school. Of course, at home parents may also reinforce this passion by encouraging study habits during the formative years of their children. Such support is vital for academic achievement.

From the perspective of social development, I think that parents are mainly responsible for guiding their

impressionable : easily influenced or affected by somebody or something

to exert influence on : to use one's power to affect somebody or something

to impart their knowledge: to pass knowledge to other people

dedicated: working very hard at something, because it is important to you

discipline: a subject that people study or are taught

to reinforce: to make a feeling or an idea stronger

formative years: having an important and lasting influence on the development of something or of somebody's character

to monitor: to watch and check

children. Firstly, they spend far more time with their children than any individual teacher is able to do. They can therefore <u>monitor</u> the activities of children outside school hours, at weekends and during holidays. Secondly, parents are able to provide role models in a whole range of situations. These might include showing respect towards <u>elders</u>, choice of friends, or proper behaviour in public when <u>eating out</u> in restaurants. In conclusion, although teachers probably have a greater effect in stimulating the intelligence of school children, <u>parental</u> influences on the development of children are stronger in social situations. 266 words	something over a period of time elders: people of greater age, experience or authority to eat out: to have a meal in a restaurant, not at home parental: connected with a parent or parents
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9. In many countries today, people in cities either live alone or in small family units, rather than in large family groups. Is this a positive or negative trend?

Essay: It is true that in recent years, many <u>urban dwellers</u> have <u>tended to</u> live on their own or in <u>nuclear families</u>. In my opinion, this trend has both positive and negative consequences in equal measure. On the one hand, the rise in smaller households is a positive trend primarily for economic reasons. <u>The migration of people from rural to urban areas</u> has	urban dwellers: people who live in a city or a town tend (to/towards something): to be likely to do something or to happen in a particular way a nuclear family: a family consisting of a father, mother and their children the migration of people from rural to urban areas: the movement of people
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resulted in an enormous increase in demand for housing. The housing stock has been inadequate to cope with this demand, and so property developers have taken advantage of this population shift to raise house prices and rents. They have built apartment blocks which provide accommodation for only single people or small families. If they do not wish to endure squalid housing conditions, therefore, it is clearly necessary for people to live alone or in small, usually family, groups.

On the other hand, there are negative aspects of this trend. With the mass exodus of people to cities, ties of kinship are broken as the extended family which lived together in the countryside is broken up. Socially, family gatherings take place only rarely and, financially, living costs can no longer be shared between many family members living under the same roof. **For example,** grandparents or other relatives used to help with household expenses, child-minding and cooking. Individuals rarely felt lonely or isolated, experiencing a sense of alienation as they sometimes do in cities, without such family support.

In conclusion, I believe that this trend has equally significant positive and negative aspects for both social and financial reasons.

from the countryside to cities

the housing stock: all the houses available for living in

to be inadequate to cope with: not good enough to deal with a problem

a property developer: a person who buys land or buildings, and then makes improvements in order to sell them for more money

apartment blocks: large buildings with apartments on each floor.

population shift: a change in the numbers of people who live in a particular area

to endure squalid living conditions: very dirty and unpleasant conditions in which to live

a mass exodus: the movement of a lot of people from a place

ties of kinship: the fact of being related in a family, with links of friendship and assistance to other family members

an extended family: a family group with many members, including parents, children, grandparents, aunts and uncles, cousins etc

to break up: to come to an end and go away in different directions

258 words	a family gathering: a meeting of family members for a particular purpose under the same roof: in the same building or house child-minding: caring informally (not in schools) for children when parents are busy or working a sense of alienation: the feeling that you have no connection with the people around you
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10. Students should **pay the full cost for their own study**, because **university education benefits individuals** rather than **society**. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Essay: It is true that some people believe that it is important to focus only on the present and future generations. However, I agree with those who argue that researching our family history is a useful and <u>worthwhile</u> activity. On the one hand, it is important to concentrate on the health, happiness and well-being of the present generation and to live <u>sustainably</u> for the sake of future generations. From the perspective of the present, everyone should try to provide a good moral example and to set <u>patterns of behaviour</u> that demonstrate respect for others. For instance, being	worthwhile: important, interesting and enjoyable. Worth spending time or money on. sustainably: in a way that can continue or be continued for a long time patterns of behavior: ways of acting and doing things (either positive or negative) formative years: a period of a person's life, usually childhood, that has a big influence on the person they
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consistently kind and honest provides a good model for children to follow during their formative years. This behaviour will shape their personality and values as they enter adult life. **In terms of** future generations, it is essential to focus on fighting climate change and to combat global warming.

On the other hand, it is also essential to have a sense of the past, including family history. This sense of history enables people to understand the socio-economic changes taking place around them today. Many people enjoy assimilating knowledge of the past by studying their family history. Discovering the origins, the occupations and some of the life stories of previous generations of family members helps to give individuals an understanding of time and place. The study of family history, therefore, bridges the generation gap and helps people to look at the past in connection with the present.

In conclusion, while it is vital to be concerned with present and future generations, I contend that it is also both interesting and important to study family history.

268 words

become later in life

to shape a child's personality/ values: to decide or influence the form of a child's personality

to enter adult life: the stage when adolescents are almost old enough to be legally independent of their parents

to fight climate change: to try to prevent changes in climate patterns, such as rainfall, temperature and winds.

global warming: the process by which the Earth is getting hotter, as a result of the greenhouse effect – in particular the increase in carbon dioxide in the air.

socio-economic changes: changes relating to the society and economy of a country

to assimilate knowledge: to absorb and understand knowledge

generation gap: the experience of not understanding your parents or grandparents and them not understanding you due to being raised during different time periods, in a

	different cultural setting to bridge: to reduce or to get rid of the differences that exist between two things or groups of people
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11. People nowadays **tend to take their family to another country when they **work abroad**. Do the **advantages** of this **outweigh the disadvantages**?**

Essay: It is true that different <u>patterns of behaviour</u> can be observed when people move to another country for work purposes. While some prefer to do this on their own and <u>remit</u> part of their salary to their family back home, many prefer to take their family with them. I believe that the benefits of taking the family outweigh the drawbacks. On the one hand, moving alone to another country may have <u>negative influences on individual families</u>. If the man goes on his own to another country to find work, to earn more money <u>to support a family</u>, this leaves the woman to cope with the task of <u>bringing up their offspring</u>. It is very stressful <u>to take on</u> all the responsibilities of <u>a single-parent household</u>, even if there are members of <u>the extended family</u> who can help. The man himself, in the new country, may find himself lonely and isolated. Despite having <u>supportive work</u>	patterns of behavior: ways of acting and doing things (either positive or negative) to remit: to send money to a place or person negative influences on individual families: negative meaning bad; influences meaning effects; on individual families refers to each nuclear family - a couple and their children, rather than families in general; to support a family: to have enough money to be able to look after a family to bring up their offspring: to bring up means to raise; this is what you do as a parent with your children; you educate them, nurture them, etc.; offspring refers to your children; to take on: to decide to do something or to agree to be responsible for somebody/something a single parent household: a family in
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<u>colleagues</u>, he may still spend part of his wages on drinking or gambling. On the other hand, moving to another country as a family may benefit the children, in particular. Firstly, although they may at first <u>be out of their depth</u> in school, children very quickly <u>pick up</u> a new language. In the new country, there may be opportunities to qualify for entrance to <u>top-tier institutions</u>, which may have been denied them at home. They may be able <u>to make the most of</u> new educational opportunities. Secondly, when the family stays together, the children receive the emotional support that they need during their <u>formative years</u>. In conclusion, I would argue that taking the family when going to another country to work is far more advantageous than leaving a wife and children behind. 286 words	which one person takes care of their child or children without a husband, wife or partner an extended family: a family group with many members, including parents, children, grandparents, aunts and uncles, cousins etc supportive work colleagues: people that you work with who give you help and encouragement to be out of one's depth: to be unable to understand something because it is too difficult to pick up: to get information or a skill by chance, not by making a big effort top-tier institutions: leading or prestigious educational institutions to make the most of something: to make something appear as good as possible; to exploit something; to get as much out of something as is possible. formative years: a period of a person's life, usually childhood, that has a big influence on the person they become later in life
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TỔNG HỢP BÀI MẪU CHỦ ĐỀ ENERGY BY NGỌC BÁCH

1. **Fossil fuels** such as coal, oil and natural gas **are the main energy source** for **many countries**. However, **some nations** are using **alternative energy** such as solar power, or wind power. To what extent do you think this is a **positive or negative development**?

Essay:

It is true that some countries have been unable to reduce their dependence of fossil fuels to meet their energy needs.

In contrast, other nations have been investing heavily in alternative energy sources and I personally consider that this is a very positive development.

Reliance on fuels such as coal, oil and natural gas has negative consequences for both human health and the environment. **Firstly**, the extraction and use of fossil fuels carries grave health risks. The burning of these fuels in power stations, or in cars or other forms of transport pollutes the atmosphere, and endangers health. It results, **for example**, in poor air quality in major cities across the world, **such as** Los Angeles, Shanghai or Sao Paulo. Admissions to hospitals rise sharply when air quality becomes critical. **Secondly**, the burning of fossil fuels adds to the greenhouse effect at a time when international efforts to reduce our carbon footprint must succeed in the effort to fight climate change.

to reduce the dependence/reliance on fossil fuels: to decrease people's consumption of fossil fuels, like oil, coal or gas

alternative energy sources: refers to any energy source that is an alternative to fossil fuel

to carry health risks: to have effects which could be bad for one's health

the greenhouse effect: the natural process by which the sun warms the surface of the Earth.

carbon footprint: a measure of the amount of carbon dioxide that is produced by the daily activities of a company or person

to fight climate change: try to prevent changes in climate patterns, such as rainfall, temperature and winds.

I believe that investment in renewable energy is essential to avoid an ecological crisis. Building wind farms and using solar panels to heat homes, factories and offices would neither pollute the air that we breathe nor deplete natural resources. **In terms of** human health, the incidence of life-threatening conditions like respiratory disorders, would be reduced. **From an environmental perspective**, this would be an environmentally-friendly energy strategy. It would minimize habitat destruction and tackle the pollution that stems from the activities of the fossil fuel extractive industries.

In conclusion, I would argue strongly that reducing reliance on fossil fuels and investing in renewable forms of energy will bring enormous positive gains for both human health and our environment.

278 words

renewable energy: energy is renewable when its source, like the sun or wind, cannot be exhausted or can easily be replaced (like wood, as we can plant trees for energy)

an ecological crisis: a serious situation that occurs when the environment of a species or a population changes in a way that destabilizes its continued survival

wind farms: an area of land on which there are a lot of windmills or wind turbines for producing electricity

to deplete natural resources: to reduce the amount of natural resources.

life-threatening conditions: illnesses which are likely to kill somebody

incidence: the extent to which something happens or has an effect

environmentally friendly: behavior or products that do not harm the environment

habitat destruction: the process that occurs when a natural habitat, like a forest or wetland, is changed so dramatically by humans that plants and animals which live there.

	to stem from: to be caused by extractive: relating to the process of removing or obtaining something, especially minerals
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